

Kapp Putsch, 1920

From Poor workers and farmers to wealthy Landowning aristocrats ⇒ right wing groups came from all classes of society

Many of them ⇒ were former soldiers ⇒ including Freikorps who had fought the Spartacists in 1919.

March 1920 ⇒ Wolfgang Kapp ⇒ led 5000 Freikorps into Berlin in a rebellion known as Kapp Putsch

Kapp ⇒ planned to overthrow Weimar Republic + return Germany to a more authoritarian system ⇒ similar to that in the time of the Kaiser

Weimar Govt ⇒ ordered German Army ⇒ to attack Freikorps and put down the rebellion. Army ⇒ refused to act against Freikorps ⇒ seemed as though Ebert's govt was doomed

However ⇒ Germany's 12 million industrial workers and trade unions ⇒ came to the rescue ⇒ declared a general strike

Country suddenly had no transport, power or water.

At the same time ⇒ all civil servants and government officials ⇒ showed support for Ebert and refused to cooperate with Kapp

After a few days ⇒ Kapp realized he could not succeed and he fled the country
→ hunted down and died awaiting trial

Seemed like ⇒ Weimar Republic had some support and power after all
→ However besides Kapp ⇒ no other rebels were punished.

Courts ⇒ set many rebels free.

Political violence from right wing ⇒ continued after Kapp Putsch ⇒ but they were rarely punished
